Cladrastis kentukea

American Yellowwood, Kentucky Yellowwood

Family: Fabaceae



HABIT



FALL



LEAF



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Deciduous tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Slow to medium
Size: 30–50 ft × 40–55 ft

Sun

Water

Soil
Well-drained preferred; adaptable

Zone 8a
Excellent for Atlanta Zone 8a. Rare native tree with fragrant flowers and yellow wood. Prefer full sun and well-drained soil. Yellow fall color. Fragrant white panicles and brown pods. High drought and alkaline tolerance. Prefer for shade or specimen. Attracts pollinators. Long-lived. Distinctive smooth bark and yellow heartwood. Southeastern specialist. Brittle wood. Prune in summer. Slow to flower

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment
Plant in full sun, well-drained soil. Provide ample space. Yellow fall color. Fragrant white panicles and brown pods. Mulch to retain moisture. High drought and alkaline tolerance. Attracts pollinators. Long-lived. Distinctive smooth bark and yellow heartwood. Southeastern specialist. Brittle wood. Prune in summer. Slow to flower

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Southeastern United States

Form
Broad rounded. American yellowwood. Broad rounded. Pinnate green leaves. Fragrant white panicles. Yellow fall color. Brown pods. Smooth gray bark. High drought and alkaline tolerance. Prefer for shade or specimen. Attracts pollinators. Long-lived. Distinctive smooth bark and yellow heartwood. Southeastern specialist. Brittle wood. Prune in summer. Slow to flower. Also known as yellowwood. Formerly C. lutea. Heartwood used as dye

Foliage
Pinnate green leaves; yellow fall color

Flowers and fruit
Fragrant white panicles; brown pods

Bark
Smooth gray

HEALTH

Health
Generally healthy. Non-toxic. Low maintenance. Prefer for shade use. Attracts pollinators. Possible canker

Symptoms
None stated